

Proportions currently married by age : Table 7.2 attempts to bring out the change in proportions of currently married women as at the Censuses of 1946, 1953, 1963 and 1971. The proportion of currently married females in the age group 15-19 years has decreased remarkably during the period 1953 to 1963. In the next higher age group of 20-24 years too the proportion of currently married females have dropped rapidly from 68.4 in 1946 to 45.9 in 1971 while for the age group 25-29 relatively small declines have been observed. Even in the age group 30-34 a reduction was noted during the intercensal period 1963-1971 from 88.6 to 85.9. These reductions indeed, dominate the declines in the birth rate witnessed during 1953-1963 and 1963-1971 which will be dealt with in greater detail in the section on fertility.

TABLE 7.2 : PROPORTION. OF WOMEN CURRENTLY MARRIED AND NEVER MARRIED BY AGE GROUPS 1946, 1953, 1963 AND 1971 CENSUSES.

Age of Women	1946		1953		1963		1971	
	Currently Married	Never Married	Currently Married	Never Married	Currently Married	Never Married	Currently Married	Never Married
15-19	23.9	75.3	23.7	75.7	14.8	85.0	10.3	89.5
20-24	68.4	29.4	65.7	32.5	57.6	41.3	45.9	53.1
25-29	84.4	11.8	84.4	12.8	81.0	17.1	73.5	24.6
30-34	87.1	6.6	87.8	7.5	88.6	8.3	85.9	10.9
35-39	85.5	4.3	86.5	5.4	89.8	4.8	89.3	5.6
40-44	78.4	4.1	80.7	5.0	86.1	4.3	87.8	4.3
45-49	71.4	3.4	73.8	4.4	81.6	3.9	84.9	3.6

Table 7.3 throws light on the relatively small reductions in the proportions of males currently married. In the age segment 15-19 very slight reductions were noted. In the age group 20-24 the proportions dropped from 18.9 in 1946 to 15.8, 15.0 and 13.6 in 1953, 1963 and 1971 respectively. In the next higher age segment 25-29 steady yet moderate declines were witnessed.

TABLE 7.3 : PROPORTIONS OF MEN CURRENTLY MARRIED AND NEVER MARRIED BY AGE GROUPS 1946, 1953, 1963 AND 1971 CENSUSES.

Age of Men	1946		1953		1963		1971	
	Currently Married	Never Married	Currently Married	Never Married	Currently Married	Never Married	Currently Married	Never Married
15-19	1.2	98.7	0.9	98.7	0.9	99.0	0.6	99.4
20-24	18.9	80.5	15.8	83.5	15.0	84.7	13.6	86.3
25-29	55.1	43.4	53.3	45.4	49.0	50.5	46.9	52.6
30-34	75.3	22.4	76.4	21.7	72.8	26.1	73.7	25.5
35-39	84.3	12.5	85.4	11.8	85.2	13.1	84.9	13.7
40-44	85.9	9.3	87.2	8.7	87.0	10.4	88.7	9.4
45-49	86.0	7.6	86.5	7.6	88.6	7.2	89.3	7.9

Proportions never married by age : Steady rises in the proportions of never married females can be seen in Table 7.2 for the age groups 15-19, 20-24, 25-29 and 30-34. The tremendous impact such changes have on fertility decline could be over-emphasised. Where the male

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